

OUR REF S2520891
(Please quote on all correspondence)

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Mrs H Thomas
Mapletree Cottage
Kings Mead
Pebmarsh
Halstead
CO9 2NA

11 April 2026

Dear Mrs Thomas

Your Subsidence Insurance Claim At: Mapletree Cottage, Kings Mead, Pebmarsh, Halstead, CO9 2NA, United Kingdom

I write to you with regard your ongoing subsidence claim and would like to provide you with an update. Following the site investigations, I am pleased to present a summary of our findings. A copy of the relevant reports is enclosed for your information.

Investigations Completed

A number of trial pits and boreholes were excavated at the property. This revealed the depth of foundations and the type and condition of sub soil beneath them.

A CCTV Survey of the drains was undertaken where accessible in order to determine their condition and establish if there are any leaks sufficient to influence the foundations.

Drain Survey

The drainage survey completed as part of our investigations identified several defects with the drains, but these are not thought to be implicated in the current subsidence movement. The ground was found to be dry and very stiff, which rules them out as a potential influence on the soils.

The drainage damage appears to be the result of physical tree root damage / ingress and is remote from the area of subsidence movement. As such, we would advise you to contact your Insurers to submit a separate drainage claim, which would normally fall for consideration under accidental damage to underground services cover.

Conclusions

The site investigation results have confirmed the presence of shrinkable clay soils, evidence of desiccation and the presence of Maple and Willow roots beneath the foundations of your property. This confirms our initial diagnosis that the subsidence damage is related to root induced clay shrinkage.

This is a commonly encountered problem and probably accounts for around 70% of subsidence claims notified to insurers. Fortunately, the cause of the problem (dehydration) is reversible. Clay soils will rehydrate in the winter months, causing the clays to swell in the cracks to close. Provided the cause of movement is dealt with (in this case, vegetation) there should not be a re-occurrence of movement.

Recommendations

The cause of the movement (in this case the nearby vegetation) needs to be dealt with first. In this instance we recommend removal of the Maple located to the right of the extension and Willow tree located at the front right of your property.

On completion of the recommended vegetation management works we will monitor the property for a short period of time to confirm stability before proceeding with superstructure crack repairs and redecoration to the subsidence damaged areas of the property.

In the meantime, we are seeking instructions from your Insurers regarding liability and will revert to you once this has been received.

Action Plan

The Action Plan below details the next actions and timescales you can expect for each stage of the claim.

Action	Target Date
Liability Decision	05/2026
Mitigation being concluded	07/2026
Monitoring concluding	01/2027
Issue of Repair Specification to ProACT	11/2026
Confirmation of repair costs & lead-in	12/2026
Repairs Starting	02/2027
Repairs Concluding	04/2027
Final update	05/2027

Later dates are dependent on completion of activities that precede them. We will keep you informed as we progress the claim and advise you of any changes to the Action Plan.

I trust I have provided an overview of how your claim is likely to progress. If you have any further questions regarding your claim, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Yours sincerely

Vicky Salter Cert CII Cert CILA

On behalf of Kim Salter Cert CILA

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For: GHG Solutions Limited

Email: correspondence@agatha.app.ghgsolutions.co.uk

Enc: Site Investigation Report
CCTV Survey

CC: Insurers